

around 12 per cent last year, while cassette sales increased by almost 19 per cent which is really impressive for a decades old format. In the US alone, cassette sales have quadrupled since 2011. High profile releases including albums from artists such as Jay Z, Taylor Swift, Lana Del Rey and even Marvel's Guardians of the Galaxy soundtracks have accounted for these massive numbers. Tape recorders or cassette players have also naturally reached new sales heights due to the aforementioned phenomenon and also because they come equipped with modern day technologies now, such as USB adaptability. Acts such as AC/DC and the Wu-Tang Clan are also entering themselves into the trend by re-releasing classic albums on cassettes.

Teasmade

Retro alarm clock-cum-hot beverage maker, Teasmade, has made a comeback. You can now be woken up from your slumber retro-style to the sound of hot water boiling in the tea-maker. These retro devices were at the pinnacle of their popularity in the 60s and 70s but witnessed a decline. Their revival, as a novelty item, was made possible by the company Swan, who dabble in all kinds of vintage technology. The new version boasts smooth edges and an illuminated LCD clock, but there's a retro version available as well which attempts to closely resemble the original Teasmade alarm clocks.

GADGETS WE WANT TO SEE RETURN

While we have been treated to some excellent reworks, reboots and resurgences of tech we all knew and loved in the past, we still yearn for the return of some that haven't resurfaced yet. Here's the list.

Concorde

This year marks the 50th anniversary since the first flight of Concorde, which took off on March 2, 1969, and travelled at supersonic speed (above the speed of



sound). The program was considered to be a tremendous success in terms of sheer innovation, however, only a mere 14 Concorde aircrafts ever entered commercial service. Created with the vision to overhaul commercial travel, the aircraft soon became commercially unviable owing to the exorbitant cost of flying the aircraft. The crash of Air France Flight 4590, in which 113 died, was the final rivet in the coffin for Concorde. However, Concorde continues to remain iconic in the aviation sector even today which has inspired multiple companies to explore the viability of supersonic travel in the present day.

Translucent gadgets

Tech enthusiasts often lament about how gadgets are becoming increasingly dreary over the years, especially smart-



phones that are all basically glass and metal bodies. The solution to the dreariness could be as simple as letting users have a look inside. Nintendo's N64 had about half a dozen see-through variants and the original iMac had a 'have-a-peek' case. Translucent gadgets incite a sense of awe in tech enthusiasts and for good reason. It breaks the monotony of the same old design and offers up something new. Sony released a translucent Limited Edition PS4 Pro in 2018, but we'd like to see translucent variants of gadgets everywhere.

Arcade Machines

Some of us have fond memories of visiting the local arcade and spending hours playing classics such as Street Fighter or Rampage. The environment of a retro arcade is also something worth reminiscing about, and newer, fancier arcades just don't have the same flair. Arcades first began popping up in the late 70s and featured popular games such as Galaxian and Space Invaders. Smash-hit games such as Pac-Man and Centipede were incorporated soon after. These machines quickly caught on with gamers since they were much more advanced than consoles such as Atari's Home Pong and also offered better visual performance. However, it's ironic that people's love for arcades is

what killed them. Developers fabricated devices that could offer the arcade experience at home – gaming consoles.

Nintendo R.O.B.

The R.O.B. by Nintendo was an authentic attempt at introducing AI into the real world. The device was a toy robot,



first launched in 1985, however it had an inordinately short lifespan that lasted only a year or so. It was allegedly the "world's first interactive robot". While

it's fun to yell "Hey Siri/Google/Alexa" at home, a robot butler would make all of them pale in comparison.

Ericsson T28

The Ericsson T28 was a compact flip phone which was manufactured in the year 1999. This phone amazed people back then, since it was not only the lightest and slimmest mobile phone at the time, but it also had a snazzy looking flip



cover that could be snapped open whenever you needed to use the keypad. We'd really love to see a rebooted version of this device where the screen of the phone

flips out to reveal an old-timey keypad. Or the keypad could be the component that flips out to reveal the full, seamless screen. Either way, it would break the monotony of present day smartphones.

Nintendo Power Glove

The Power Glove, produced by Mattel in 1989, was released as an accessory to play games on the original NES. Actions such as waving your hand, clenching your first or simply pressing buttons allowed you to control the game. It's basically like the Wii before the Wii, except it's a glove and wearing it would make you feel



like some kind of wizard. However, while the idea was sound, the execution was simply terrible